

COLORADO FIELD ORNITHOLOGISTS SIGHT RECORD FORM

CFO-RC FILE #:

Red 7/1/00 up (photo)

RESULTS :

7-0A

PLEASE PRINT OR TYPE. ATTACH PHOTOGRAPHS AND ADDITIONAL PAGES IF NECESSARY.

SPECIES: LITTLE BLUE HERON EGRETTA CAERULEA
(Common Name) (Scientific Name)

DATE(S) OF OCCURRENCE: 5/19/00 AND 5/20/00

NUMBER OF BIRDS SEEN: 1 SEX: ♂ PLUMAGE: ADULT

EXACT LOCATION: IRRIGATION DITCH IN PASTURE ON REYNOLD'S FARM, GREELEY

COUNTY: WELD NEAREST TOWN: EVANS, CO. (GREELEY) ELEVATION: 4600'
OFF & ON

LENGTH OF OBSERVATION: SEVERAL HOURS TIME(S) OF OBSERVATION: ALL DAY

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO SAW THE BIRD(S) WITH YOU:

JOE HIMMEL 5/19 & 5/20
DICK MAXFIELD 5/20
SUSAN HIMMEL - 5/19 & 5/20

OTHER OBSERVERS WHO INDEPENDENTLY SAW THE BIRD(S):

NONE KNOWN

LIGHT CONDITIONS (QUALITY; DIRECTION RELATIVE TO BIRD(S); POSITION):

SUNLIGHT

OPTICAL EQUIPMENT USED: B&L BINOCES, KOWA SCOPE

DISTANCE FROM BIRD (ESTIMATED UNLESS OTHERWISE NOTED): 50 yd.

WAS BIRD PHOTOGRAPHED? YES IF SO, HAVE YOU SUBMITTED PHOTOS? YES

WHO TOOK THE PHOTOGRAPHS? DICK MAXFIELD

DESCRIBE THE GENERAL AND SPECIFIC HABITAT IN WHICH THE BIRD(S) OCCURRED:

IRRIGATION DITCH.

DESCRIBE THE BIRD'S BEHAVIOR (FLYING; FEEDING; HABITS; BEHAVIORS USED IN IDENTIFYING THE SPECIES OR IN SUPPORTING THE IDENTIFICATION):

FEEDING SLOWLY & DELIBERATELY.

DESCRIBE THE BIRD IN DETAIL. THIS IS THE MOST IMPORTANT PART OF THIS REPORT. INCLUDE THE OVERALL SIZE AND SHAPE AND HOW YOU PLACED THE BIRD IN THE GENERAL GROUP THAT YOU DID. GIVE COMPLETE DETAILS OF PLUMAGE, INCLUDING HEAD, THROAT, UNDERSIDES, NAPE, BACK, WINGS AND TAIL. GIVE PARTICULAR EMPHASIS TO MARKS YOU USED TO IDENTIFY THE BIRD(S). DESCRIBE OTHER DETAILS, SUCH AS COLOR AND SHAPE OF BILL, LEGS, EYE, ETC. THAT WERE IMPORTANT IN MAKING THE IDENTIFICATION. (FILL OUT THIS PORTION EVEN IF PHOTOGRAPHS ARE SUBMITTED; YOU MAY ATTACH ADDITIONAL SHEETS, DRAWINGS, FIELD SKETCHES OR COPY OF FIELD NOTES):

MID-SIZE HERON. TOTALLY BLUE, WITH MAROON WASH ON NECK & HEAD. BILL BI-COLOR, DARK TIP AND LIGHTER BASE, DARK LEGS.

DISCUSS SIMILAR SPECIES AND HOW YOU ELIMINATED THEM:

TRICOLORED HERON HAS WHITE BELLY, STRIKE FROM BILL DOWN NECK. REDDISH EGRET DOES NOT HAVE BLUE BODY. HAS A SHAGGY HEAD AND NECK, FEED WITH A COMPLETELY DIFFERENT TECHNIQUE

WHAT IS YOUR PRIOR EXPERIENCE WITH THIS AND SIMILARLY APPEARING SPECIES?

NONE

LIST BOOKS, GUIDES, RECORDINGS OR OTHER SOURCES CONSULTED AND HOW THIS INFLUENCED YOUR IDENTIFICATION (DURING AND AFTER OBSERVATION):

NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC FIELD GUIDE, 3RD EDITION

THIS REPORT WAS MADE FROM NOTES MADE DURING ☒ OR AFTER ☐ OBSERVATION, OR LATER FROM MEMORY ☐.

DATE OF WRITTEN REPORT: 5/22/00

REPORTING OBSERVER: JOE HIMMEL

SIGNATURE: Joe Himmel

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FOUND BY SUSAN HIMMEL